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MSCA Fellow of the Month_2026 Call for Applications

Fields marked with * are mandatory.



Call open for nominations

Are you an #MSCA fellow and would like to let people know about yourself & your research? Each month, we highlight one exceptional researcher whose work and journey stand out. If you're passionate about your research and want to inspire others, **apply to become our next MSCA Fellow of the Month by submitting your details via the form below.**

Fellows will be chosen by the European Commission based on criteria including:

- **the quality and relevance of their research**
- **its societal or policy impact**
- **the geographic and thematic diversity of their projects**

If you have any questions, you can contact us directly at EAC-MSCA-COMMUNICATION@ec.europa.eu (mailto:mail to: EAC-MSCA-COMMUNICATION@ec.europa.eu).

Please note: The application form is currently open for submissions for fellows who have not been featured as a *Fellow of the Month* so far. Re-submissions for fellows, who have previously applied but

have not been selected is allowed.

Personal information

Please state your name as you would like it to be displayed on our website, if selected:

***1 Name(s)**

Dipankar

***2 Surname(s)**

Bhattacharya

***3 What are your pronouns?** (The text will be drafted in third person, therefore your answer will help us understand the best way to address you. For instance: choose "he/him" if you would like your post to say "He graduated with honours...").

- ☐ She/her
- ☒ He/him
- ☐ They/them
- ☐ I prefer not to say
- ☐ Other

***5 Nationality**

India

***6 Contact email:**

d.bhattacharya1@imperial.ac.uk

***7 Name of your MSCA project:**

CASREx: Cable-driven Arm Soft Reconfigurable Exoskeleton for Muscle-Impairment Rehabilitation.

***8 Grant agreement ID of your project:**

101205678

***9 Field of research/expertise:**

Engineering

*11 Are you a member of the Marie Curie Alumni Association (MCAA)

*The MCAA is an international non-profit organisation and alumni community for current and previous beneficiaries of the MSCA. The Association offers its members lifelong professional development, networking, and advocacy opportunities. The MCAA membership is **free**. For more information, visit the MCAA website (<https://www.mariecuriealumni.eu/>).*

☐ Yes

☒ No

Summary of your research

*1 Please write a summary of your career and research activities

2,000 character(s) maximum

Example:

"Ronald completed his BEng in Civil Engineering in his home country, Guyana, followed by his MSc studies at Newcastle University in the UK. In February 2018, he started his PhD within the #MSCA SMARTI ETN (Sustainable Multi-functional Automated Resilient Transport Infrastructures European Training Network) at the University of Palermo in Italy.

His project – SUROMA (Sustainable Road Management through low-cost techniques), is based on using innovative and low-cost tools and techniques for road pavement analysis. This aims at helping road authorities who have deficient budgets and need low-cost tools to help them better manage road networks. He uses imagery in his project collected from cell phones, low-cost cameras and drones to analyse pavements. This will help reduce costs associated with conditional surveys and will help authorities do more with fewer resources! 3D modelling techniques are being used for pavement distress identification and analysis. His project also uses deep learning techniques for predicting maintenance activities and detecting pavement distresses. Combined, these tools are being used to optimize aspects of pavement management strategies."

Dipankar completed his B.Tech. in Electronics and Communication Engineering at NERIST in India, his M.Tech. in Systems and Control at IIT Roorkee, and his Ph.D. in Mechatronics Engineering at the University of Auckland, where he built a robotic soft esophagus with embedded sensing and model-predictive control for evaluating endoprosthetic stents. After working as a Senior Research Engineer at the TransGP garment-production centre in Hong Kong, where implemented imitation-learning policies for fabric manipulation, and a postdoc prior to it at the CUHK in the area of cable driven robotics, he was awarded a Marie Skłodowska-Curie Fellowship in 2025 to lead the CASREx (Cable-driven Arm Soft Reconfigurable Exosuit for Muscle-Impairment) project at Imperial College London.

He designs a cable-driven soft reconfigurable exoskeleton for upper-limb rehabilitation. Everyday tasks such as carrying a cup of coffee without spilling, or holding a tool steady when someone bumps past, depend on a hidden layer of motor control: the nervous system regulates not only the motion of the arm but also its mechanical impedance, ramping endpoint stiffness up before a disturbance, peaking it at contact, and letting it decay once stability returns. After stroke, this regulation is often the part that breaks, leaving survivors able to reach but unable to keep the hand stable when loaded or bumped. Conventional rehabilitation and kinematic robots treat visible movement, and the largest UK trial (RATULS, n=770) showed that high-dose robot therapy did not beat usual care.

His fellowship tackles the missing ingredient to combine human experiments with EMG, a digital twin of the manipulator-exosuit platform, and reinforcement learning to learn how healthy adults decide to stiffen the arm against disturbance, and translates the recovered objective into a quantitative design framework for an adaptive cable exosuit that can reproduce that strategy when the patient's own impedance is impaired.

***2 Please write a summary of the science outreach activities you have been involved in:**

800 character(s) maximum

Example:

"Ronald has actively been engaged in several outreach activities, from the annual European Researchers' Night in Palermo, to conferences in Rome, South Korea and Spain. He has also been a part of the wide-ranging series of training events organised by SMARTI in Palermo, Granada, Nantes and as far as Melbourne, where discussions on the advancement of transport infrastructures have taken centre stage."

Dipankar has actively contributed to science outreach and training at Imperial College London. As Assistant Supervisor at the Dyson School of Design Engineering, he supervises two Year 3 MEng students, one PhD student, and the DESE 71002 Robotics Research Projects course. He has delivered invited departmental seminars at a.) Dyson and b.) Imperial Robotics Postgraduate Committee on learning-based fabric manipulation, a guest lecture on PyDrake simulation, and two online Morph Lab sessions. His work has been accepted at prestigious IEEE IROS 2026 conference, which he will present in October 2026. He was selected for the European Talent Academy 2026 in collaboration with TUM and Polimi, and presently working on two Imperial Connect Fund collaborations.

***3 Please write a quote summarising your experience as an MSCA fellow:**

800 character(s) maximum

Example:

"As an MSCA fellow, I was given a unique opportunity to work in a network of other researchers working together towards making transport infrastructures better. I have benefited from the network's global experts from both industry and research. The fellowship has provided me with the platform for training in many different aspects of my research, to see and experience many different places and to grow as a professional. Whilst the project has been a challenge, SMARTI has definitely been an unforgettable and amazing time in my life and I owe tremendous gratitude towards the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions and all the great people within the SMARTI ETN project."

As an MSCA fellow, I have had the rare opportunity to work on a problem that genuinely affects people's lives. Everyday tasks, such as carrying a cup without spilling when bumped, rely on the brain's invisible regulation of arm stiffness. This function is often impaired after stroke and not yet addressed by current rehabilitation exosuits. The fellowship enabled me to advance this research at Imperial's Morph Lab with Prof. Nanayakkara, combining human experiments, digital twins, and learning-based control, while building collaborations with TUM, Polimi, and the MSCA network. I have also supervised students, taught robotics, delivered invited talks, and had a paper accepted at IROS 2026. I am deeply grateful to MSCA and everyone in CASREx for this formative experience.

***4 Please explain your research as if you were pitching it to a 10 year old or your neighbour:**

800 character(s) maximum

Imagine carrying a cup of coffee when someone suddenly bumps you. If your arm is too loose, the coffee spills; if it stiffens just enough, the cup stays steady. Healthy brains make these adjustments automatically by tuning muscle activity and elbow stiffness, but after a stroke this hidden control often breaks down, leading to shaking, wobbling, or loss of stability. My research develops a soft robotic sleeve for the arm that learns how a healthy elbow stiffens during disturbance and helps stroke survivors recover similar support. By combining muscle recordings, a digital twin of the arm, and soft cable-based actuation, the system gently assists the joint when needed. The goal is to help people carry a cup, hold a tool, and stay steady when the world pushes back.

6 If you have one, please write here your LinkedIn profile:

<http://www.linkedin.com/in/dipankar-bhattacharya-phd-imperial>

7 If you have one, please write here your X (formerly Twitter) profile:

8 Please write here any other relevant website where you provide more information about your research and would be willing to share with wider audiences/public (project website / Facebook / X (formerly Twitter), LinkedIn, Researchgate or research profile, laboratory page, etc.):

(Company) <https://profiles.imperial.ac.uk/d.bhattacharya1>

(Personal) <https://bhattner143.github.io/dips/>

<https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=4BBRfsMAAAAJ&hl=en>

(Researchgate) https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Dipankar-Bhattacharya?ev=hdr_xprf

*9 I wish to receive updates on similar events and funding opportunities through the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions (MSCA) Newsletter (<https://ec.europa.eu/newsroom/eac/user-subscriptions/2309/create>).

- ☒ Yes
☐ No

Privacy Statement

1 Please read the privacy statement for the 'Fellow of the Month' initiative

[Privacy_statement_Fellow_of_the_month_2026.pdf](#)

☒ I have read and agree with the privacy statement linked to submitting my application for the 'Fellow

of the Month' initiative. I consent to my personal data and other information being collected, processed and stored by organisers in accordance with applicable European data protection regulations. I am aware that this consent can be withdrawn via e-mail to EAC-MSCA-COMMUNICATION@ec.europa.eu.

*2 If selected, I consent to provide a photograph of myself in accordance with the data privacy notice above.

- ☒ Yes
☐ No

Thank you

Thank you for your application! We are always happy to hear from our fellows. We will contact you soon to check the final text of your publication. If you have any question, please contact us: EAC-MSCA-COMMUNICATION@ec.europa.eu (<mailto:EAC-MSCA-COMMUNICATION@ec.europa.eu>)

Meanwhile, for more MSCA-related updates, we invite you to follow us on LinkedIn:

- Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions (<https://www.linkedin.com/company/mscactions/>) (MSCA)
- European Research Executive Agency (<https://www.linkedin.com/company/european-research-executive-agency-rea/>) (REA)
- Marie Curie Alumni Association (<https://www.linkedin.com/company/mariecuriealumni/>) (MCAA)

Contact

Contact Form (</eusurvey/runner/contactform/MSCAFellowOfTheMonth>)
